

Curriculum Vitae

Qingze Zhu

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EDUCATION

Columbia University, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences 09/2026–05/2027
Master of Arts (M.A.) in Sociology

University of Wisconsin-Madison 10/2020–12/2025
Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Statistics

MITx Certificate: Computer Science and Programming Using Python; MITx Micromasters: Supply Chain Management

University of Amsterdam Coursera Certificate: Classical Sociological Theory; Research Methods in Sociology

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant: Marketization of Agricultural Technology and Farmer Income Differentiation 01/2026–08/2026

Peking University Institute of Advanced Agricultural Sciences Supervisor: Prof. Ruifa Hu

- Coordinated fieldwork for a multi-round household panel survey across three prefectures in Shandong Province; trained enumerators and supervised data-quality protocols covering 40+ villages and 1,000+ greenhouse-farming households on smart-device adoption, labor allocation, marketing channels, risk preferences, and social trust.
- Cleaned and processed panel data for 587 households and 1,295 greenhouse observations (16,000+ variables) using Python and Stata; performed outlier verification, per-mu standardization, and descriptive statistics.
- Led a systematic review and meta-analysis of 30 years of commercialized Bt cotton and maize, providing quantitative evidence on the erosion of technology dividends and its implications for smallholder welfare.
- Completed the cotton module to date: screened 319 papers, cleaned and harmonized 47 studies with 218 yield observations; preliminary findings show an average yield gain of 33.7% from Bt cotton, but a statistically significant annual decline of ~1.3% ($p < 0.05$) in the yield advantage over time since commercialization.

Fieldwork Lead: Rural Livelihoods & Direct-Sales Pilot 07/2021–08/2022

Majiaba Village, Zigui County, Hubei, China

Year 1:

- Conducted mixed-methods research on income drivers among ~200 citrus-farming households (stratified survey + semi-structured interviews); produced anonymized datasets and interview transcripts.
- Identified dependence on single sales channels and long intermediary chains as key constraints on bargaining power, price realization, and income stability.
- Interviewed Supply & Marketing Cooperative staff and township officials to compile a 30-year oral history of marketing-channel changes and to assess shifting forms of state and cooperative support.

Year 2:

- Designed and implemented the “Orange Warms the Countryside” WeChat Mini Program to pilot direct sales and basic vendor-managed inventory for local households.
- Introduced ABC supplier tiering and simple stock-management practices; over six months, reduced spoilage by 25% and helped 10 farmers achieve a collective income increase of ¥100,000.

Independent Research: Processing Location and Value Capture in Cross-Border Agricultural Supply Chains 05/2025–09/2025

University of Wisconsin–Madison, Madison, WI

Supervisor: Prof. Sinan Tas

- Examined how processing-location decisions shape smallholder participation in cross-border agricultural value chains, using China→US konjac trade as a case.
- Built an arrival-rate-conserving network-flow model to formalize trade-offs between “fresh → processed” conversion at origin vs. destination under different logistics and loss structures.

- Found that processing near origin ports can reduce total landed cost by 52.8% (\$20,119→\$9,492) and effective loss by 62.4%; derived simple rules whose recommendations agree with the optimizer in 96% of cases.
- Produced a working paper and fully reproducible code/data package shared with partner cooperatives to support their strategy discussions on near-origin processing and farmer income stability.

Research Assistant: Computational and Interactive Visualization Tools for Statistical Instruction

09/2025–12/2025

University of Wisconsin–Madison, Madison, WI

Supervisor: Prof. Bo Yang

- Built interactive course tools and use handouts with JavaScript/Python, including an animated derivation from discrete random walk to Brownian motion; developed a probability knowledge map with hover highlights and click-through links to notes.
- Standardized R Markdown/Quarto outputs: added chunk options, code folding, and show/hide controls to improve HTML readability and reproducibility.
- Developed a Brownian-motion–based classroom model to illustrate income volatility for smallholder farmers under different intermediary and price regimes, using visualizations to prompt discussion about rural risk and inequality.

WORKING PAPERS & PREPRINTS

- Zhu, Qingze. 2025. “Processing Location for Cross-Border Perishables with Arrival-Rate-Conserving Conversion: Thresholds, Strategy Frontiers, and a China–US Case.” [SSRN working paper](#)
- Zhu, Qingze. 2025. “Multi-Echelon Inventory Optimization Framework with ABC-XYZ Classification: Evidence from Simulation-Based Validation.” [SSRN working paper](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

“Agrarian Platform Capitalism in Practice: How E-commerce Governance Extracts Value and Transfers Risk to Small Farmers.” 17th Conference of the European Sociological Association, Warsaw, Poland. August 2026. (Forthcoming)

“Digital Market Access, Unequal Services: How Platform Rules Shape Farmers’ Net Returns and Risk.” 76th Annual Meeting of the Society for the Study of Social Problems, New York, NY. August 2026. (Forthcoming)

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Supply Chain Consultant

12/2022–11/2023

Zhejiang Yangtian Trading Co., Ltd.

- Managed data and inventory systems for a multi-store e-commerce operation spanning 20 online store-fronts, ~4,200 SKUs, 3 distribution centers, and 5 contract factories.
- Analyzed how platform commission structures, promotion rules, rating mechanisms, and logistics constraints shape pricing, assortment, and fulfillment performance for small and mid-sized suppliers.
- Standardized ERP master data—SKU coding, units of measure, inventory-age management, and in-transit tracking—to support differentiated replenishment for core and long-tail items.
- Built alert dashboards for stockouts, long-tail demand, and negative inventory; raised inventory record accuracy to 97.5% and OTIF to 98%, cut stockouts by ~45% and inventory turnover days by 30, releasing roughly ¥4.5–5.2 million in working capital.

Regional Lead, China

12/2022–06/2023

SOAR International

- Collected, vetted, and evaluated international volunteer-service programs; ran information sessions at universities in neighboring provinces and led volunteer recruitment and interviews.
- Managed the organization’s Xiaohongshu and WeChat public accounts, writing and publishing outreach content on volunteer service.

Program Initiator & Coordinator: Pediatric ICU Volunteer Partnership

02/2021–06/2022

Wuhan Children’s Hospital

- Established a point-to-point partnership between campus volunteers and ICU units; organized weekly selection/training and weekend bedside activities (games/companionship).
- Held supportive conversations with parents of children under treatment (e.g., leukemia/brain tumors); compiled anonymized needs lists and connected families with charities/social services.